

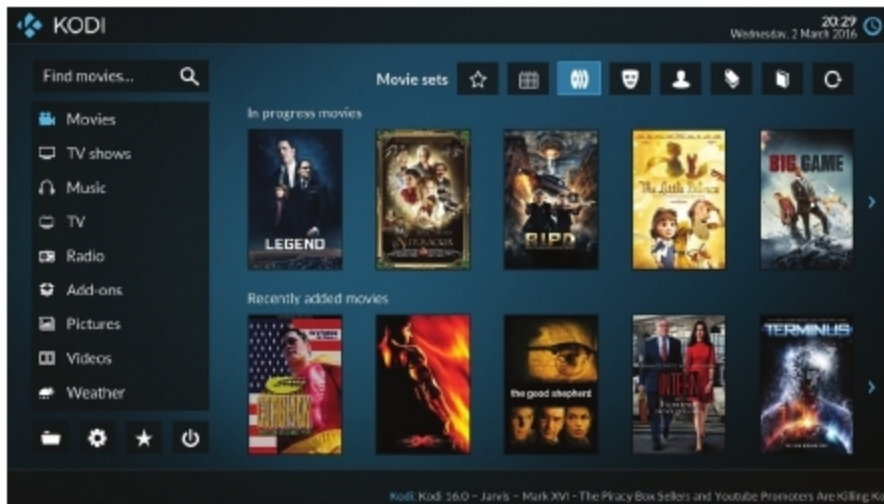


Figure 1: Kodi GUI

- **Gaming:** Kodi has strong support for gaming, with a 'games manager'. It provides a unified games manager library and GUI front-end launcher with online metadata Web scraping support for information about the games. Soon, Kodi will be integrated with Retro Games support.
- **Add-ons/plugins:** Kodi has an Addons Framework architecture and an Addons Manager GUI client, which connects to a decentralised digital distribution service platform that serves add-on apps and plugins which, among other things, provide online content to Kodi.

Kodi versions

There are many versions of Kodi, a few of which are listed below.

- **Kodibuntu:** This is a free Ubuntu based Linux distribution with Kodi.
- **Kodi for OS X:** This runs on Mac OS X Tiger and later versions.
- **Kodi for Windows, iOS and Android.**

Latest version: 17.6 (Krypton)

Official website: <https://kodi.tv/>

2. Plex

Plex is secure, open source, powerful and fully featured easy-to-install media server software that supports multiple platforms — Windows, MacOS and others. The Plex media server is based on a client-server model. It offers a wide range of client apps for different devices to support and stream its media server content easily.

Plex Media Server was originally called Plex Media Center and was based on Kodi, formerly known as XBMC. Plex transforms the media library by adding metadata like cover art and IMDb results to enhance your viewing experience. Plex also transcodes on the fly, and automatically adjusts its performance and quality for the available bandwidth.

Technical features

- Automatically indexes content from online sources like iTunes, iPhoto and Aperture, and has a huge metadata database to provide information regarding video content.

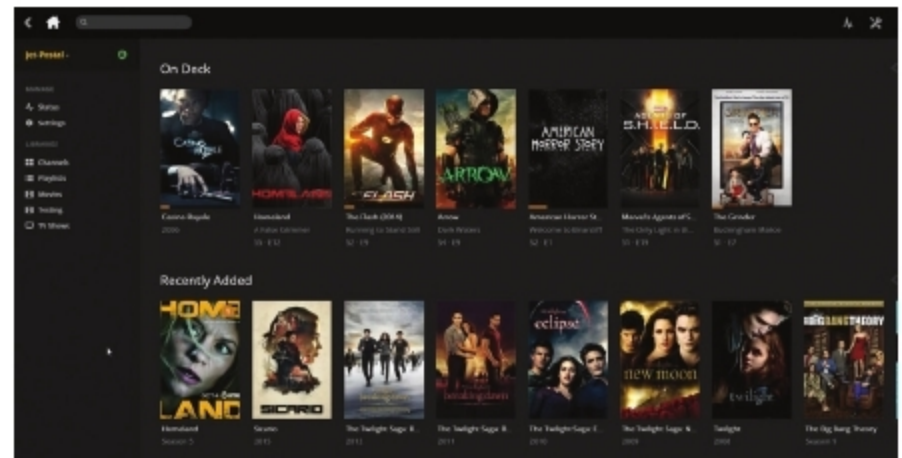


Figure 2: Plex GUI

- Automatic metadata gathering of information and artwork stored in the Plex library.
- Easy and user friendly Web UI with SSL support.
- Able to decode HD video to 4K as well as 10-bit H.264 sources.
- Has loads of third party add-ons and plugins.

Latest version: 1.14.1.5488

Official website: <https://www.plex.tv>

3. Emby Media Server

Emby is open source, powerful and cross-platform media server software with features and a user interface similar to Plex. It features a REST based API with built-in documentation to facilitate client development. The Emby media server is available for multiple operating systems like Windows, Linux, Mac OS, Docker and FreeBSD. It is also available on Amazon Fire TV, Apple TV, Chromecast, Raspberry Pi, and even game consoles like the PlayStation 4 and Xbox One. Emby also has the benefit of third-party support, with a few apps available in the store. The best of these is, probably, Ember.

Emby offers centralised database management, which can be accessed through a Web based management tool. The Emby database manager offers a few more features than what you see in Plex. One of the best methods to manage a multimedia database in Emby is through the built-in Metadata Manager. This lists all the graphical icons of the user's movies and shows, indicating what metadata (images, trailers, subtitles, etc.) might be missing.

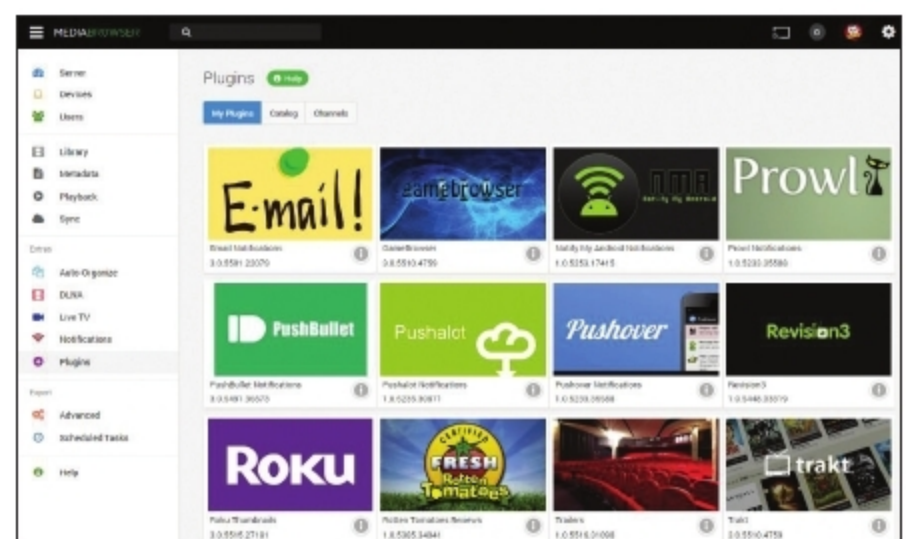


Figure 3: Emby GUI